



FEELING THE PINCH

INDIAN HOUSEHOLDS ARE FEELING THE HEAT OF THE WEST ASIA CONFLICT AS HIGHER ENERGY AND RAW MATERIAL PRICES HAVE CREPT INTO EVERYDAY BUDGETS. WILL CONSUMPTION SLOW DOWN?

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BY **SURABHI**

ALARM BELLS Over the last few months, the cost of the war in West Asia has begun trickling into household budgets

► **WORRIES OVER POOR MONSOON, IT SECTOR JOB LOSSES KEEP DEMAND OUTLOOK UNCERTAIN**



I**N APRIL THIS** year, industrial belts across Delhi-NCR witnessed a wave of worker protests that

disrupted operations and prompted several states to revise minimum wages. The demonstrations, driven by long working hours, low pay, and poor working conditions, were intensified by workers' anger over persistently high inflation and a sharp rise in cooking gas prices, which further eroded the purchasing power of already meagre wages.

With the West Asia war impacting energy and fuel supplies, prices of cooking gas had surged to over ₹500 a kg and the cost of a cylinder was running into thousands in the black market.

While this was seen as a one-off issue, over the last few months, the cost of the war in West Asia has begun trickling into household budgets. Not just cooking gas, prices of a bevy of household items, from fuel and staples like milk, dairy products, and biscuits to detergents and consumer goods like air conditioners have risen.